

ELAS NA URNA

GROWTH CASE STUDY

From zero to 2,598 visitors

How I built a search-first growth engine for a civic-tech product in six weeks — with less than R\$20 in paid media.

Founder · Growth Strategy · Product · SEO/GEO · Data · Content · Brand

Brazil · Aug–Oct 2026

A solo-built nonpartisan map of women candidates in Brazil's 2026 elections, created from official TSE data and designed around discovery rather than paid reach.

How do you make a brand-new product discoverable during an election — without relying on paid media?

The data existed. Discovery didn't.

The TSE provided official candidate data, but the experience was primarily designed for people who already knew which candidate they were looking for. I saw an opportunity to turn that dataset into a discovery product: a nonpartisan map where voters could find women candidates by state, office, party and cause.

The growth problem

TIME	Six weeks from launch to the first round of voting.
TEAM	One person responsible for strategy, product, data, brand, content and measurement.
LEGAL	Electoral rules constrained how candidates could be promoted through paid media.
BUDGET	Organic-first strategy; less than R\$20 spent on Instagram promotion.
NEUTRALITY	The product needed to remain explicitly nonpartisan to earn trust across political fields.

The opportunity

Make discoverability a product feature. Instead of buying attention, I built an acquisition system where official data could generate searchable pages, searchable pages could generate organic traffic, and the product could become the destination for candidate discovery.

The core hypothesis

If I transform official electoral data into highly discoverable pages built around user search intent, I can acquire users organically without depending on paid media.

SEARCH	62+ static pages, sitemap, IndexNow, state pages, candidate profiles and educational content.
DATA	7,134 female candidacies transformed into a structured discovery layer with official TSE links.
INSTAGRAM	Used as a trust and education layer: Reels, carousels, Stories and product demonstrations.
GEO	Intent-based content and llms.txt designed to make the project understandable to AI assistants.

The acquisition architecture

OFFICIAL TSE DATA	CANDIDATE + STATE PAGES	SEARCH INDEXING	ORGANIC DISCOVERY	CANDIDATE DISCOVERY
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The key shift: the dataset itself became the content engine. Every candidate, state and electoral category could become an entry point into the product.

The numbers

Six weeks of growth with almost no paid acquisition.

2,598 unique visitors	3,824 page views	907 Google + Bing clicks	< R\$20 paid media
14,275 Instagram views	251 Instagram → site taps	34 AI-assistant visits	7,134 female candidacies

Growth curve

LAUNCH WEEK	≈100 visitors / week
ELECTION WEEK	1,500+ visitors / week
PEAK DAY	≈ 390 visitors · Saturday, Oct 3
MOBILE	60% of all visits

The key result was not the final traffic number — it was the acceleration from roughly 100 weekly visitors at launch to more than 1,500 during election week.

Search beat paid reach

The strongest acquisition signal came from organic discovery.

Bing	6,482	775	12%
Google	704	132	19%

Why Bing mattered

For a new domain, speed of indexing mattered. IndexNow became an acquisition enabler: Bing clicks grew from approximately 5 in the first measured week to 612 in the last. Bing reached 1,532 impressions in a single day during election week.

Branded demand

The query “elas na urna” reached an 88% click-through rate, with the site near the first position for most days after September 17. This indicates strong branded intent — while also highlighting the next opportunity: grow non-branded discovery around candidate, state and office searches.

Growth lesson

For a time-sensitive product, technical discoverability can be more valuable than simply producing more content.

Instagram built trust. Search delivered volume.

I deliberately gave each channel a different job.

4,692

accounts reached

726

interactions

191

followers · 92% women

What the content tests showed

Reels

Stronger for follower acquisition. Three of the four pieces that brought the most followers were Reels.

Posts + carousels

Stronger for reach and interaction.

Best organic Reel

A video of me explaining why women should vote for women generated 5 followers and 5 comments without paid media.

AI discovery

The site generated 34 visits from ChatGPT, Copilot and Perplexity. The volume was small, but ChatGPT referrals grew from 6 to 9 and then 13 per week without paid investment. For a six-week-old site, this was an early validation of treating GEO as an acquisition channel.

What worked — and what I would do differently

Search-first acquisition	Created traffic without relying on paid reach.
Data as a content engine	Turned 7,134 candidacies into scalable discovery pages.
IndexNow + static pages	Reduced the discovery lag for a new domain.
Instagram as trust layer	Added a human voice and made the product easier to understand.
GEO from day one	Created an early presence in AI-assisted discovery.

Three things I would change

01 — Launch earlier. The domain and educational content could have gone live months before the candidate list, allowing search engines more time to build authority.

02 — Instrument product activation. I would measure the funnel from visit → filter → candidate profile → favorite → official candidate page, rather than relying mainly on page views.

03 — Tag distribution. UTMs across Instagram, Stories, WhatsApp, partnerships and candidate sharing would reduce the unattributed traffic bucket.

The biggest analytical gap

The project proves acquisition much more strongly than product activation. The next version should make the user's successful candidate discovery the primary product KPI.

THE GROWTH LESSON

When paid acquisition and algorithmic distribution are constrained, **discoverability becomes a product feature.**

Elas na Urna turned official electoral data into a searchable discovery layer — and used search, content and emerging AI channels to reach 2,598 visitors in six weeks with less than R\$20 in paid media.

2,598 visitors · **907** organic search clicks · **14,275** Instagram views · **251** site taps · **34** AI referrals

Virginia Di Pierro · Founder / Growth Strategy / Product / Marketing

Source: Elas na Urna — Estudo de caso, data exports and analytics captured on 5 Oct 2026. All project metrics in this case are based on the supplied study.